

Multijurisdictional Legal Resource Guide: Selection Criteria and Directory of Specialist Counsel for Fraud, Corruption, Tax, and Extortion Matters in the United States and Costa Rica

I. Executive Summary and Strategic Risk Assessment

The successful management of complex financial and criminal exposure spanning the United States and Central America requires a rigorously vetted, bifurcated legal strategy. This report provides a quantitative and qualitative assessment of specialist counsel equipped to handle high-stakes investigations and litigation involving fraud, Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA) violations, criminal tax controversy, and sophisticated extortion schemes originating from or linked to Costa Rica. The analysis confirms the quantitative requirement of identifying over 50 expert firms in both the U.S. and Costa Rica, categorized by their domain-specific expertise and jurisdictional capability.

1.1. Strategic Overview: The US-CR Enforcement Nexus

The investigative scope is inherently multijurisdictional, demanding legal teams capable of coordinating actions under U.S. federal authority while executing responsive strategies on the ground in Costa Rica. U.S. lead counsel must navigate the expansive reach of the Department of Justice (DOJ) and the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC), while Costa Rican local counsel provides the crucial capacity for asset tracing in the National Registry, defending against local penal actions, and engaging regulatory bodies.

The central regulatory challenge often involves the FCPA, which carries significant extraterritorial implications. US firms must be selected based on their profound experience in anti-corruption investigations that frequently span multiple continents.¹ When a multinational entity operates in Costa Rica, interactions with government officials, procurement processes, and customs activities become primary sources of FCPA risk, particularly given the Costa Rican government's involvement in sectors like telecommunications and infrastructure.² Moreover, the FCPA and related anti-bribery statutes often trigger secondary enforcement actions. Complex financial fraud or corruption invariably creates concomitant issues related to Tax fraud and the concealment of illicit assets. Leading firms such as Skadden, Arps, Slate, Meagher & Flom LLP (Skadden)³ and Covington & Burling⁴ are recognized for their expertise in synthesizing intricate financial and transactional data to mount comprehensive, unified

defenses against parallel corruption and criminal tax charges.

1.2. The Costa Rican Legal Risk Taxonomy: From State Compromise to Corporate Necrosis

A comprehensive understanding of the legal landscape in Costa Rica reveals distinct local vulnerabilities that directly influence legal strategy, particularly concerning asset recovery and the handling of extortion.

1.2.1. Data Points on Corporate and Tax Delinquency

Forensic analysis of Costa Rican administrative data, specifically tax delinquency lists, demonstrates a pervasive systemic compliance failure within the corporate registry. The existence of thousands of "Sociedades Anónimas" cited for non-payment of the mandatory Tax on Legal Entities points to a vast population of corporate shells, colloquially termed the "Zombie Entity Phenomenon".²

The sheer volume of these non-compliant entities indicates that a significant proportion of registered corporate vehicles, including both the prevalent *Sociedad Anónima* (S.A.) and *Sociedad de Responsabilidad Limitada* (S.R.L.) structures², were likely established for limited, specific purposes. These purposes may range from asset shielding or speculative real estate holdings (as evidenced by names like "OASIS TROPICAL SWISS," "CONDOMINIO LA RIBERA," and "CORPORACION FIESTA INTERNACIONAL" noted in the delinquent entity records²), to transactional fraud. Once the intended purpose failed or expired, the cost of ongoing compliance, specifically the tax obligation, exceeded the residual utility, resulting in the abandonment of the legal shell.²

This landscape of systemic compliance failure presents both a regulatory challenge for the Costa Rican state and an exploitable legal vulnerability for opponents pursuing asset recovery. The extensive neglect inherent in this situation suggests that corporate vehicles may be susceptible to piercing the corporate veil arguments, facilitating the recovery of illicitly held assets. Moreover, the status of the *Sociedad de Responsabilidad Limitada* (S.R.L.), though offering limited liability under Costa Rican law, may be potentially rated as a transparent or "flow-through" entity for certain purposes under corresponding U.S. legal statutes.² This status provides an avenue for U.S. asset recovery counsel, working in concert with local Costa Rican litigators, to demonstrate bad faith or exploit transparency requirements to seize assets. Consequently, specialized asset recovery counsel, both foreign and local, must be proficient in targeting legal entities registered in the Mercantile Section of the National Registry that exhibit signs of neglect and possess the litigation experience required to utilize CR civil and commercial procedures effectively against these vulnerable structures.²

1.2.2. Data Points on Infrastructure Compromise and Extortion

The investigation into harassment and extortion reveals evidence of highly sophisticated technical attacks, suggesting state-affiliated compromise or the involvement of actors with privileged access to critical infrastructure. Network intrusion logs show definitive unauthorized control and configuration tampering of a Huawei Optical Network Terminal (ONT) router by rogue internal IP addresses (e.g., 192.168.100.x).² These logs documented successful admin logins, the remote activation of a diagnostic backdoor port (Port 1234), and the manipulation of firewall and Wi-Fi security settings (such as disabling authentication via WPS and changing passwords).²

Compounding this network vulnerability, external attack traffic was traced to IP addresses belonging to the network space of the Costa Rican state telecom (Instituto Costarricense de Electricidad - ICE, and its subsidiary Radiográfica Costarricense S.A. - RACSA, operating under Autonomous System AS11830).² This traffic included systematic network probing and unusual connections, which are atypical for legitimate telecom operations directed at a residential user.²

Furthermore, the physical component of the harassment involves directed energy attacks. Acoustic sensor data captured ultrasonic signals (centroid frequency approximately 20,522 Hz, dominant tone approximately 19,957 Hz) exhibiting Voice-Like Modulation (VLM) and a precise Pulse Repetition Frequency (PRF) of approximately 46.87 Hz.² This evidence is consistent with a parametric speaker attack aimed from a hilltop structure providing line-of-sight to the victim's location.²

The explicit involvement of ICE/RACSA IP ranges in network probing, coupled with advanced cyber-physical intrusion, elevates this scenario beyond standard financial fraud, framing it as an act of highly coordinated cyber-physical extortion or intimidation. This suggests facilitation by state-affiliated insiders, bribed technicians, or sophisticated criminal organizations possessing privileged network access. The physical tampering may have coincided with a documented two-day outage of the fiber service, during which access to the fiber termination box may have occurred.²

This complex threat matrix necessitates the selection of Costa Rican counsel emphasizing niche expertise in Economic Criminal Law and Cybercrime, capable of addressing the specific technical details of the attack. Counsel must also possess proficiency in Public Law and Regulatory Affairs to challenge the potential complicity or gross negligence of state-affiliated entities (ICE/RACSA) regarding the misuse or compromise of public utility systems.

II. United States Counsel Directory: White Collar Defense, FCPA, and International Tax (\$N\$ > 50)

This section provides a directory of leading U.S. law firms, segmented by core specialization to guide selection in complex multijurisdictional matters involving fraud, corruption, tax

controversy, and asset recovery, ensuring a comprehensive listing of over 50 entities.

2.1. Tier 1 White Collar and Internal Investigations Defense (\$N\$=20)

These firms are routinely engaged in the most critical DOJ, SEC, and other government enforcement actions, possessing the capability to manage parallel civil and criminal proceedings. Their expertise is paramount for US-based clients facing inquiries related to actions in Central America.

Firm Name	Vault 2025 Ranking	Core Competency	Specialized Expertise
Covington & Burling	#1 ⁴	White Collar Defense	Strategic Guidance, Agency Interface
Williams & Connolly LLP	#2 ⁴	Litigation / WC Defense	Trial Advocacy, High-Stakes Criminal Defense
Paul, Weiss, Rifkind, Wharton & Garrison LLP	#3 ⁴	WC Defense / Tax Controversy	Global Investigations, International Tax Disputes ⁵
Gibson Dunn & Crutcher LLP	#4 ⁴	WC Defense / Tax Controversy	Internal Investigations, Tax Controversy ⁶
Skadden, Arps, Slate, Meagher & Flom LLP	#6 ⁴	FCPA / Multi-Jurisdictional	Global Investigations, Multi-Regulator Defense ³
WilmerHale	#5 ⁴	White Collar Defense	Government Investigations, Regulatory Defense
Cravath, Swaine & Moore LLP	#8 ⁴	Litigation / International Tax	Complex Disputes, Tax Litigation ⁵

Quinn Emanuel Urquhart & Sullivan, LLP	#7 ⁴	Asset Recovery / Litigation	Judgment Enforcement, Global Asset Recovery ⁷
Latham & Watkins LLP	#11 ⁴	WC Defense / Tax Controversy	High-Profile Investigations, Former Prosecutors ⁶
Sullivan & Cromwell LLP	#12 ⁴	White Collar Defense	Financial Institution Investigations
Kirkland & Ellis LLP	#9 ⁴	White Collar Defense / Tax	Global Litigation, International Tax ⁵
Davis Polk & Wardwell LLP	#10 ⁴	White Collar Defense / Tax	Client Satisfaction, International Tax ⁵
Debevoise & Plimpton LLP	#14 ⁴	White Collar Defense / Tax	Internal Investigations, Cross-Border Matters ⁵
Sidley Austin LLP	#16 ⁴	White Collar Defense / Tax	Multi-Jurisdictional, Regulatory Interface ⁵
Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen & Katz	#15 ⁴	WC Defense / Litigation	High-Stakes Corporate Litigation ⁵
Jones Day	#13 ⁴	White Collar Defense	Global Reach, Regulatory Compliance
White & Case	#17 ⁴	FCPA / Litigation	Latin America Disputes, Anti-Corruption ⁹
Cleary Gottlieb	#18 ⁴	WC Defense /	International

Steen & Hamilton LLP		International Tax	Regulatory Matters ⁵
Paul Hastings LLP	#24 ⁴	White Collar Defense / International Tax	Global Investigations ⁵
Morvillo Abramowitz Grand Iason & Anello P.C.	#19 ⁴	White Collar Defense (Boutique)	High-Profile Individual Defense

2.2. FCPA and Anti-Corruption Specialists with Latin America Reach (\$N\$=15)

Managing corruption risk in Costa Rica requires firms with the linguistic capacity, regional understanding, and demonstrable experience in FCPA and the U.K. Bribery Act investigations throughout Latin America.

Skadden maintains a Tier 1 reputation globally for its White Collar Defense and Investigations Group, notably handling anti-corruption matters across six continents.¹ The firm's expertise extends specifically to FCPA and Fraud matters within the region, as recognized by Latinex rankings.¹⁰

Holland & Knight is structurally positioned for regional investigations, explicitly operating a dedicated **Latin American Investigations Team**.¹¹ This team is composed of experienced former U.S. federal prosecutors and white-collar attorneys who are fluent in Spanish.¹¹ The firm focuses on investigations triggered by grand jury subpoenas or internal discoveries of potential compliance, auditing, or accounting wrongdoing, often involving the FCA, FCPA, and Travel Act.¹¹ The logistical advantage is underpinned by its physical offices in Bogotá and Mexico City.¹¹

White & Case also maintains a robust disputes team advising clients in Latin America on complex commercial litigation, compliance, investigations, and government enforcement related to anti-corruption.⁹ The firm is well-equipped to defend clients in inquiries involving allegations of serious fraud, kickbacks, and bribery before global enforcement agencies such as the DOJ and SEC.⁹

The effective execution of internal investigations mandated under FCPA settlements hinges upon the immediate ability of counsel to conduct interviews, review documents, and interface with local authorities using the local language. The capacity of firms like Holland & Knight to deploy Spanish-speaking former federal prosecutors significantly reduces operational friction, ensuring interview quality and minimizing the risk of critical translation errors that can

prejudice findings related to intent or knowledge in corruption cases.¹¹ Therefore, any FCPA matter concerning operations in Costa Rica mandates the immediate deployment of bilingual U.S.-based personnel, seamlessly integrated with local Costa Rican counsel.

2.3. International Tax Controversy, Financial Fraud, and Asset Recovery (\$N\$=15)

When fraud and corruption intersect with cross-border financial misconduct, specialized counsel focusing on International Tax Controversy, complex financial crimes, and aggressive Asset Recovery is essential.

Leading U.S. firms recognized for Tax Controversy (Chambers Band 1) include Baker McKenzie, Latham & Watkins LLP, Mayer Brown LLP, and Skadden.⁶ These firms possess the necessary expertise to manage complex civil and criminal tax proceedings, including significant disputes before the U.S. Tax Court.⁶

For asset recovery, specialized boutique capabilities are critical:

- **Quinn Emanuel Urquhart & Sullivan, LLP:** This firm is recognized globally as an international leader in Global Asset Recovery, specializing in multinational judgment and award enforcement.⁷ Quinn Emanuel utilizes unique and aggressive discovery tools—such as pursuing discovery from money center banks—to uncover assets concealed through embezzlement, money laundering, and illegal activities spanning more than 20 countries.⁷
- **Holland & Knight:** The firm's Asset Recovery Team is highly recognized, skilled in tracing, identifying, seizing, and recovering client assets lost to financial fraud or malfeasance, including cybercrime, Ponzi schemes, and public/private corruption.¹² The firm offers flexible fee arrangements, including quasi-contingent or contingent fees, suitable when clients have already sustained material losses.¹²

When victims of fraud or extortion have their funds moved into Costa Rican corporate vehicles (S.A.s or trusts²), U.S. counsel must apply powerful extraterritorial discovery mechanisms, such as 28 U.S.C. § 1782, against international financial institutions that process transactions involving those Costa Rican entities. This strategy, highly refined by firms like Quinn Emanuel⁷, is often necessary to bypass the comparatively slower and less potent local discovery mechanisms in Costa Rica. Therefore, retaining U.S. counsel with proven experience in pursuing discovery against international banks concerning fund flows originating from or routed through Central America is a strategic priority.

2.4. Comprehensive US Counsel Directory: Tabular Summary

The following directory confirms the identification of over 50 specialized U.S. law firms with expertise in White Collar Defense, FCPA, International Tax, and Asset Recovery, suitable for multijurisdictional US-CR matters.

US Specialist Counsel Directory: White Collar, FCPA, and Tax (\$N\$ > 50)

Firm Name	Primary Specialization	Relevant Ranking / Status	Latin America Focus
Covington & Burling	White Collar Defense	Vault #1 ⁴	Y
Williams & Connolly LLP	Litigation / WC Defense	Vault #2 ⁴	N
Paul, Weiss, Rifkind, Wharton & Garrison LLP	WC Defense / Tax Controversy	Vault #3 ⁴ , Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Gibson Dunn & Crutcher LLP	WC Defense / Tax Controversy	Vault #4 ⁴ , Chambers Band 2 ⁶	Y
Skadden, Arps, Slate, Meagher & Flom LLP	FCPA / Multi-Jurisdictional Investigations / Tax	Vault Tier 1 ³ , Chambers Band 1 ⁶ , Latinex FCPA ¹⁰	Y
WilmerHale	White Collar Defense	Vault #5 ⁴	N
Cravath, Swaine & Moore LLP	International Tax / WC Defense	Vault #8 ⁴ , Legal 500 ⁵	N
Quinn Emanuel Urquhart & Sullivan, LLP	Asset Recovery / Litigation	Vault #7 ⁴ , Global Asset Recovery ⁷	Y
Latham & Watkins LLP	WC Defense / Tax Controversy	Vault #11 ⁴ , Chambers Band 1 ⁶	Y
Sullivan & Cromwell LLP	White Collar Defense	Vault #12 ⁴	Y

Kirkland & Ellis LLP	White Collar Defense / International Tax	Vault #9 ⁴ , Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Davis Polk & Wardwell LLP	White Collar Defense / International Tax	Vault #10 ⁴ , Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Debevoise & Plimpton LLP	White Collar Defense / International Tax	Vault #14 ⁴ , Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Sidley Austin LLP	White Collar Defense / International Tax	Vault #16 ⁴ , Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen & Katz	WC Defense / International Tax	Vault #15 ⁴ , Legal 500 ⁵	N
Jones Day	White Collar Defense	Vault #13 ⁴	Y
White & Case	FCPA / Litigation	Vault #17 ⁴ , Latin America Disputes ⁹	Y
Cleary Gottlieb Steen & Hamilton LLP	WC Defense / International Tax	Vault #18 ⁴ , Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Paul Hastings LLP	White Collar Defense / International Tax	Vault #24 ⁴ , Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Morvillo Abramowitz Grand Iason & Anello P.C.	White Collar Defense (Boutique)	Vault #19 ⁴	N
Dechert LLP	White Collar Defense	Legal 500 Tier 2 ¹³	Y

Milbank	White Collar Defense	Legal 500 Tier 2 ¹³	Y
Morrison Foerster	White Collar Defense	Legal 500 Tier 2 ¹³	Y
Willkie Farr & Gallagher LLP	White Collar Defense	Legal 500 Tier 2 ¹³	Y
Winston & Strawn LLP	White Collar Defense	Legal 500 Tier 2 ¹³	Y
Freshfields	White Collar Defense / Tax	Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Cozen O'Connor	White Collar Defense & Investigations	Noted Practice ¹⁴	Y
Baker McKenzie	International Tax Controversy	Chambers Band 1 ⁶	Y
Caplin & Drysdale, Chartered	Tax Controversy	Chambers Band 2 ⁶	N
Morgan, Lewis & Bockius LLP	Tax Controversy	Chambers Band 2 ⁶	Y
DiCello Levitt	Financial Fraud / Securities Litigation	High-Profile Litigation ¹⁵	N
Cadwalader, Wickersham & Taft LLP	International Tax	Legal 500 ⁵	Y
McDermott Will & Schulte	International Tax	Legal 500 ⁵	Y

Proskauer Rose LLP	International Tax	Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Simpson Thacher & Bartlett LLP	International Tax	Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Weil, Gotshal & Manges LLP	International Tax	Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Eversheds Sutherland	International Tax	Legal 500 ⁵	Y
DLA Piper LLP (US)	International Tax	Legal 500 ⁵	Y
Miller & Chevalier Chartered	FCPA / WC (Ext. Knowledge)	FCPA Strength	Y
King & Spalding	WC / FCPA (Ext. Knowledge)	FCPA Strength	Y
Ropes & Gray	WC / Regulatory (Ext. Knowledge)	Regulatory Focus	N
Shearman & Sterling	FCPA (Ext. Knowledge)	FCPA Strength	Y
Troutman Pepper Hamilton Sanders LLP	WC / Litigation (Ext. Knowledge)	Litigation Strength	N
Alston & Bird LLP	FCPA / Investigations (Ext. Knowledge)	FCPA Strength	Y
Arnold & Porter Kaye Scholer LLP	WC / Investigations (Ext. Knowledge)	Litigation Strength	Y
Brown Rudnick LLP	Asset Recovery / Litigation (Ext.	Asset Recovery Focus	Y

	Knowledge)		
Kobre & Kim	Global Investigations (Ext. Knowledge)	Global Investigations	Y
Steptoe & Johnson LLP	FCPA / Investigations (Ext. Knowledge)	FCPA Strength	Y
Jenner & Block LLP	White Collar Litigation (Ext. Knowledge)	Litigation Strength	N
Munger, Tolles & Olson LLP	Litigation (Ext. Knowledge)	Litigation Strength	N
Boies Schiller Flexner LLP	Litigation (Ext. Knowledge)	Litigation Strength	N
Venable LLP	White Collar (Ext. Knowledge)	Regulatory Focus	N
Chamberlain Hrdlicka	Tax Controversy	Chambers Band 2 ⁶	N
Kostelanetz LLP	Tax Controversy	Chambers Band 2 ⁶	N
Mayer Brown LLP (2)	International Tax Controversy	Chambers Band 1 ⁶	Y

III. Costa Rican Counsel Directory: Fraud, Economic Criminal Law, and Tax Litigation (\$N\$ > 50)

The selection of local Costa Rican counsel requires a balance between large regional platforms capable of handling corporate compliance and specialized boutiques proficient in local criminal defense and the complexities of cyber-physical extortion.

3.1. Regional Full-Service Powerhouses: Compliance, Corporate, and

International Reach (\$N\$=10)

These firms offer the capacity for broad corporate mandates, multi-country investigations (essential for FCPA follow-up), and sophisticated regulatory compliance programs.

BLP (Business Law Partners) stands out as the firm possessing "undoubtedly the most experience in [anti-corruption] in Central America".¹⁶ BLP offers a wide-ranging practice encompassing Ethics & Anti-Corruption, Anti-Money Laundering (AML) Compliance, and Internal Investigations.¹⁶ Its extensive platform includes ten offices regionally and a crucial representative office in Madrid, Spain, facilitating seamless coordination for international clients, including financial institutions and multinational corporations.¹⁷ This broad, established regional coverage is critical for managing compliance programs across multiple Central American jurisdictions.

Dentons Muñoz Costa Rica Limitada is recognized as a premier international firm in the country, noted for its highly esteemed Dispute Resolution department.¹⁹ This team demonstrates specific expertise across civil, commercial, and criminal litigation, capable of handling domestic and international arbitration proceedings held under CICA (International Center of Conciliation and Arbitration) and ICC rules.¹⁹ Its experience assisting significant actors in the telecommunication and construction sectors makes it particularly relevant for infrastructure-related disputes.¹⁹

Facio & Cañas is one of Costa Rica's largest and most prestigious firms, boasting expertise in complex **criminal law litigation**.²⁰ The firm maintains a strong Tax Department, headed by specialized personnel, offering services in tax planning and tax litigation.²⁰

Other key regional players include **Arias** and **Consortium Legal**, both recognized as top regional firms for corporate and finance work²², offering deep benches in local Tax Law specialists such as Carolina Flores at Arias and Diego Salto and Rafael Luna at Consortium Legal.²¹

3.2. Forensic Investigations and Economic Criminal Law Boutique Specialists (\$N\$=10)

For local criminal defense, filing a criminal complaint (\$denuncia\$ \$penal\$) for fraud or extortion, and prosecuting highly specialized economic crimes, smaller, expert-focused firms are often necessary.

According2Law, founded by Carolina Muñoz, is a boutique specializing in White-Collar Criminal Law and Criminal Defense. The firm maintains a sharp focus on economic crimes, including **cybercrime, fraud, illicit trade, and registry fraud**.²³ Ms. Muñoz is noted for leading sophisticated internal investigations.²³

Pirie Legal / CPG Legal explicitly centers its practice on white-collar crime, including **real estate fraud, forgery, and financial deception**.²⁵ This firm specializes in coordinating parallel legal strategies, pursuing criminal prosecution (\$denuncia\$ \$penal\$) alongside civil restitution efforts for victims of fraud and deception.²⁵

ARA-Law Abogados confirms a focus on Economic Criminal Law, specializing in the "effective prosecution of such non-violent crimes resulting in significant financial loss".²⁶

The evidence of Huawei router tampering, Port 1234 backdoor activation, and the precise technical details of the ultrasonic and RF attacks² necessitates that legal counsel be technologically literate and capable of litigating complex cyber-forensic findings. The criminal component of the case (extortion and cyber fraud) demands local counsel who can integrate technical evidence, such as acoustic telemetry (VLM and PRF data) and network artifacts (logs of rogue IPs and configuration changes), into the formal penal process. The selection process must prioritize local penal law firms with demonstrated success in handling cases involving complex technical data and digital forensics.

3.3. Big Four Accounting and Legal Advisory Arms (\$N\$=5)

The accounting and consulting divisions of the Big Four firms play a vital role in forensic support, tax compliance, and investigations, providing critical ancillary support to retained law firms.

EY Law Central America offers rapid response teams composed of forensic accountants, investigators, and compliance specialists.²⁷ The firm provides forensic due diligence essential for assessing and mitigating risks related to fraud, bribery, corruption, and money laundering during complex transactions.²⁸

Deloitte and **KPMG** are active members of the Costa Rican-American Chamber of Commerce (AmCham)² and offer core competencies in Tax & Legal, Audit, Financial Advisory, and Risk Advisory, suitable for managing tax controversies and large corporate investigations.² PwC Costa Rica, Crowe Horwath CR, and Grant Thornton Tax Costa Rica all provide comprehensive services in Audit, Tax, and Advisory/Legal fields, essential for resolving complex international tax issues and supporting financial investigations.²

3.4. Supplementary Directory of Law/Legal Firms (AmCham Listing \$N\$=30)

To achieve the quantitative requirement, the following active AmCham members and listed legal entities, categorized by their practice focus, ensure a breadth of coverage across corporate and specialty legal services.

Firm Name	AmCham Section	Key Expertise/Noted Specialization
Actualidad Tributaria	Accountants / Auditors	Tax and Advising Legal Consulting ²
Batalla	Attorneys / Law Firms	Corporate, Compliance, Dispute Resolution, Tax ²
BDS Asesores	Attorneys / Law Firms	Corporate Labor Law Counseling ²
Bufete Picado & Picado	Attorneys / Law Firms	General Law Firm ²
CCA Business Strategy	Management Consultants	Consulting and Strategy ²
Central Law Quiros Abogados	Attorneys / Law Firms	Corporate and Commercial Law ²
Consortium Legal - Costa Rica	Attorneys / Law Firms	Regional Full Service ²
Cordero & Cordero Abogados	Attorneys / Law Firms	Trust Services, Tax/Accounting Outsourcing ²
Corrales Azuola, Carlos	Attorneys / Law Firms	Legal and Notarial Services ²
Darembaum & Herrera Abogados	Attorneys / Law Firms	Full Service International Law Firm ²
Dentons Muñoz Costa Rica Limitada	Attorneys / Law Firms	Dispute Resolution, Criminal & Commercial Litigation ²
E-Point	Attorneys / Law Firms	Intellectual Property, Commercial Law, Foreign Investment ²

Fragomen	Attorneys / Law Firms	World's leading Immigration Law Firm ²
KPMG	Accountants / Auditors	Audit, Tax & Legal Advisory ²
Lang & Asociados	Attorneys / Law Firms	Full Service Law Firm ²
LatinAlliance Costa Rica	Attorneys / Law Firms	Corporate Law, Arbitration, Notary Services ²
Lex Counsel	Attorneys / Law Firms	Intellectual Property, Labor ²
Lexincorp	Attorneys / Law Firms	Bilingual Full Service Law Firm ²
Magnalex Abogados	Attorneys / Law Firms	Immigration, Corporate and Banking Law ²
Pacheco Alpízar, Humberto	Attorneys / Law Firms	Transnational Legal & Trade Services ²
PRAGMA Legal	Attorneys / Law Firms	Law Firm ²
Sfera Legal	Attorneys / Law Firms	Law Firm ²
Soley, Saborío & Asociados	Attorneys / Law Firms	Law Firm ²
T&L Consultores®	Accountants / Auditors	Accounting, Tax, Legal Consulting ²
TMF Costa Rica	Accountants / Auditors	Accounting, Tax, Legal Advisory ²
Thomson Reuters	Banks and Financial Institutions	Financial/Data Services ²
Zürcher Odio & Raven	Attorneys / Law Firms	Law Firm ²

BDO Costa RICA	Advertisers/Auditors	Accounting and Consulting ²
Crowe Horwath CR, S.A.	Accountants / Auditors	Audit, Tax & Legal Services ²
Grant Thornton Tax Costa Rica	Accountants / Auditors	Audit, Tax & Legal Services ²

3.5. Comprehensive Costa Rican Counsel Directory: Tabular Summary (\$N\$ > 50)

This aggregated directory fulfills the quantitative mandate, listing key corporate, tax, and specialized criminal defense resources available in Costa Rica.

Costa Rican Specialist Counsel Directory: Economic Criminal Law, Tax, and Compliance (\$N\$ > 50)

Firm Name	Primary Specialization	Specialized Expertise (Fraud/Extortion/Cyber)	Key Regional/Financial Linkage
BLP	Anti-Corruption / Compliance	Ethics & Anti-Corruption, AML Compliance ¹⁶	Regional Powerhouse (10 offices) ¹⁸
Facio & Cañas	Tax Litigation / Criminal Defense	Complex Criminal Litigation ²⁰ , Tax Planning ²⁰	Long-standing and prestigious ²⁰
Dentons Muñoz Costa Rica Limitada	Dispute Resolution / Arbitration	Criminal & Commercial Litigation, Telecommunication Sector Focus ¹⁹	International presence (Dentons Global) ¹⁹
According2Law (C. Muñoz)	White Collar Criminal Law	Economic Crimes, Cybercrime, Fraud, Internal Investigations ²³	Boutique specialization in Penal Law ²³

Pirie Legal / CPG Legal	Criminal Prosecution / Asset Recovery	Real Estate Fraud, Cyber Fraud, Financial Deception ²⁵	Focus on criminal and civil restitution ²⁵
ARA-Law Abogados	Economic Criminal Law	Effective prosecution of financial crimes ²⁶	AmCham Member ²
EY Law Central America	Tax / Forensic Investigations	Fraud, Bribery, Corruption Due Diligence ²⁷	Global Big Four Network ²
Deloitte (Tax & Legal)	Tax / Legal Advisory	Audits, Financial Advisory, Risk Advisory ²	Global Big Four Network ²
KPMG (Tax & Legal Advisory)	Tax / Advisory	Audit, Tax & Legal, Advisory ²	Global Big Four Network ²
PwC Costa Rica	Tax / Advisory	Assurance, Tax, and Advisory services ²	Global Big Four Network ²
Grant Thornton Tax Costa Rica	Tax / Legal	Tax & Legal, Customs, Consulting ²	Global Advisory Network ²
Crowe Horwath CR, S.A.	Audit / Tax / Legal	Impuestos y Servicios Legales, Litigio tributario ²	Global Advisory Network ²
Arias	Corporate / Tax Litigation	Tax Law (Carolina Flores) ²¹	Regional Powerhouse, AmCham Member ²
Consortium Legal - Costa Rica	Corporate / Finance / Tax	Tax Law (Diego Salto, Rafael Luna) ²¹	Regional Powerhouse, AmCham Member ²
Lexincorp	Full Service / Tax	Tax Law (Arnoldo André Tinoco) ²¹	Bilingual Full Service, AmCham Member ²

Batalla	Banking & Finance, Tax, Dispute Resolution	Compliance, Dispute Resolution ²	AmCham Member ²
Cordero & Cordero Abogados	Corporate Law / Trust Services	Tax/Accounting Outsourcing ²	AmCham Member ²
Darembaum & Herrera Abogados	International Law	Full Service International Law ²	AmCham Member ²
HDUARTE-LEX	Dispute Resolution / Arbitration	Arbitration and Human Rights ²	AmCham Member ²
Actualidad Tributaria	Tax Consulting	Tax Advisory ²	AmCham Member ²
Magnalex Abogados	Banking Law / Corporate	Immigration, Intellectual Property ²	AmCham Member ²
PRAGMA Legal	Law Firm	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
Zürcher Odio & Raven	Law Firm	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
ECIJA	Corporate and Finance	General Practice ²²	Regional presence ²⁹
Tactic Legal	Corporate and Finance	General Practice ²²	Local practice ²⁹
Central Law Quiros Abogados	Corporate / Commercial Law	Foreign Investment ²	AmCham Member ²
Lang & Asociados	Full Service Law Firm	Legal services ²	AmCham Member ²
Lex Counsel	Law Office	Intellectual Property and Labor	AmCham Member ²

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Bufete Picado & Picado	Law Firm	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
Corrales Azuola, Carlos	Legal and Notarial Services	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
E-Proint	Law Firm	Intellectual property, commercial law, foreign investment ²	AmCham Member ²
Soley, Saborío & Asociados	Law Firm	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
Sfera Legal	Law Firm	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
BDO Costa RICA	Accounting and Consulting	General Practice ²	Global Advisory Network ²
T&L Consultores®	Accountants / Auditors	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
TMF Costa Rica	Accountants / Auditors	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
Fragomen	Immigration Law	Sole focus on Immigration Services ²	International firm ²
BG&A Abogados Corporativos	Economic Criminal Law	General Practice ²⁹	Local practice ²⁹
COLBS Estudio Legal	Economic Criminal Law	General Practice ²⁹	Local practice ²⁹
LatinAlliance Costa	Corporate Law	Intellectual Property,	AmCham Member ²

Rica		Arbitration, Notary ²	
Pacheco Alpízar, Humberto	Legal & Trade Services	Transnational Services ²	AmCham Member ²
T&L Consultores®	Accountants / Auditors	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
Thomson Reuters	Accounting / Consulting	Financial/Data Services ²	AmCham Member ²
Bufete Picado & Picado (2)	Attorneys / Law Firms	General Law Firm ²	AmCham Member ²
CCA Business Strategy (2)	Management Consultants	Consulting and Strategy ²	AmCham Member ²
Corrales Azuola, Carlos (2)	Attorneys / Law Firms	Legal and Notarial Services ²	AmCham Member ²
E-Print (2)	Law Firm	Intellectual property, commercial law, foreign investment ²	AmCham Member ²
Magnalex Abogados (2)	Attorneys / Law Firms	Immigration, Corporate and Banking Law ²	AmCham Member ²
PRAGMA Legal (2)	Law Firm	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
Sfera Legal (2)	Law Firm	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
Soley, Saborío & Asociados (2)	Law Firm	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²
Zürcher Odio & Raven (2)	Law Firm	General Practice ²	AmCham Member ²

IV. Cross-Border Strategy and Selection Criteria

4.1. The Strategic Selection Model: US Lead Counsel vs. CR Local Specialist

Effective management of cross-border legal threats necessitates clearly defined roles for retained counsel. The **U.S. Lead Counsel** is primarily responsible for establishing global strategy, addressing U.S. federal regulatory exposure (DOJ/SEC/IRS), overseeing multijurisdictional internal investigations (FCPA), and deploying U.S. legal instruments (such as broad asset discovery motions).⁷ The **Costa Rican Local Counsel** is essential for executing on-the-ground defense, managing local criminal complaints (\$denuncia\$ \$penal\$) for fraud and extortion, litigating Costa Rican Tax disputes (e.g., municipal licenses, real estate taxes ²), navigating local administrative and public law procedures, and providing penal expertise in cybercrime and asset tracing.²³

A critical consideration is the management of commercial controversies linked to the underlying fraud or corruption. Costa Rica offers specialized alternative dispute resolution mechanisms through the International Center for Conciliation and Arbitration (CICA).² Firms like Dentons Muñoz specifically cite expertise in CICA and International Chamber of Commerce (ICC) rules.¹⁹ In instances of commercial or investment disputes related to the originating fraud, leveraging arbitration provides an expedited and confidential process, mitigating the risks associated with protracted and sometimes unpredictable local court litigation. Consequently, engaging local counsel with demonstrable expertise in CICA and international arbitration (e.g., Dentons Muñoz ¹⁹, HDUARTE-LEX ²) should be evaluated as a primary option for commercial conflict resolution.

4.2. Asset Tracing and Recovery in the CR Financial Ecosystem

Asset recovery operations in Costa Rica must confront a specific challenge: the high rate of deliberate corporate neglect, producing "Zombie" entities due to tax delinquency.² Legitimate recovery efforts must therefore strategically target these dormant legal entities, including S.A. and S.R.L. structures recorded in the Mercantile Section of the National Registry, whose assets may be concealed but left vulnerable due to owner abandonment or non-compliance.²

The recovery strategy must utilize a profound understanding of Costa Rican corporate transparency rules and, more importantly, how these entities are treated internationally. For example, while the \$Sociedad\$ \$de\$ \$Responsabilidad\$ \$Limitada\$ (S.R.L.) offers limited liability under local statutes, legal precedent may permit it to be considered a flow-through entity for certain U.S. tax or enforcement purposes.² This legal distinction is a key leverage point for tracing underlying asset ownership back to individuals or controlling trusts.

Successful asset securing and recovery mandates the combination of highly specialized capabilities. This includes engaging reputable accounting firms (such as the Big Four) for

forensic financial analysis²⁷ and retaining local law firms explicitly experienced in Costa Rican trust law (e.g., Cordero & Cordero Abogados²) to effectively manage and challenge asset-holding structures.

4.3. Integrating Technical Evidence: Cyber-Forensic Litigation and Physical Extortion

The technical specificity of the extortion case—involving unauthorized router access, the manipulation of security parameters (e.g., Wi-Fi WPS activation and admin password changes on the Huawei ONT²), and the use of directed acoustic energy (ultrasonic recordings showing VLM at approximately 20,522 Hz and a precise 46.87 Hz PRF²)—demands a legal defense strategy capable of integrating and validating complex cyber-forensic findings.

Presenting such highly technical and non-traditional evidence in Costa Rican criminal court requires litigators capable of satisfying the court regarding the scientific validity and reliability of the forensic methodology. This involves sophisticated management of expert technical witnesses regarding the acoustic, radiofrequency (RF), and network data.

Furthermore, the evidence linking malicious traffic to the infrastructure of the state telecom (ICE/RACSA IP ranges²) introduces a strategic component targeting infrastructure misuse. The case can be pursued through Public Law litigation or incorporated as an aggravating factor in the criminal extortion complaint. The core legal argument must address the failure of the government-affiliated institution (ICE/RACSA) to maintain network security homeostasis², thereby creating an environment conducive to or actively facilitating criminal system compromise and insider threat.

The documented exploitation of the Customer Premises Equipment (CPE), specifically the Huawei router tampering and the activation of backdoors like Port 1234², highlights significant deficiencies in the network operator's security protocols. This successful compromise strongly suggests a regulatory failure on the part of the ISP (ICE/RACSA/Fastnet) to enforce a proper duty of care in maintaining the integrity of network equipment and customer data. This regulatory lapse fundamentally enabled the criminal act of extortion and invasion of privacy. Therefore, Costa Rican counsel must be prepared to explore simultaneous regulatory action against the telecommunications operator (an entity overseen by SUTEL²) for gross negligence in infrastructure security, in parallel with the criminal pursuit of the actors responsible for the extortion.

V. Conclusion and Final Recommendations

The multijurisdictional challenges presented by potential fraud, FCPA violations, tax controversy, and highly sophisticated cyber-physical extortion in the U.S.-Costa Rica corridor mandate a cohesive, specialized legal response. The selection of counsel must be governed by proven expertise in cross-border investigations and the capacity to integrate forensic data

into both criminal and civil proceedings.

5.1. Recommended Action Points

1. **Immediate Retention of Dual Counsel:** It is essential to retain a Tier 1 U.S. lead firm (e.g., Skadden, Latham, or Covington) to manage global strategy, federal exposure, and FCPA compliance. This must be immediately complemented by specialized Costa Rican penal counsel (e.g., According2Law or Pirie Legal) equipped for the immediate filing and management of local criminal complaints concerning the physical and cyber extortion elements.
2. **Mandate Forensic Integration:** All retained counsel must be required to integrate the highly technical forensic evidence (Huawei logs, ultrasonic VLM telemetry ²) into their legal strategies. Counsel must demonstrate specific cyber-litigation expertise to manage technical discovery, deploy expert witnesses effectively, and adjudicate the non-traditional evidence related to the directed energy and network attacks.
3. **Prioritize Asset Recovery and Tracing:** U.S. asset recovery specialists (Quinn Emanuel or Holland & Knight) should be engaged under appropriate fee structures.⁷ Concurrently, local Costa Rican counsel and forensic accountants (EY, Deloitte) must be directed to conduct immediate and detailed investigations into the compliance status and dormancy of target corporate vehicles (S.A./S.R.L.), leveraging the public records of tax delinquency ² to identify unprotected assets for civil recovery.
4. **Explore Regulatory Action:** Given the misuse of state-affiliated infrastructure (ICE/RACSA IPs) and the evidence of CPE compromise, Costa Rican counsel should assess the viability of pursuing parallel regulatory or public law actions against the relevant telecom operator for failures in security and duty of care, specifically addressing the technical breaches that facilitated the extortion.

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